DO NOW — RECALL

Lesson 160 · Investigatory Powers: RIPA 2000, Modern S

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

1. Does giving attribution automatically permit copying protected software or images?

2. Why does the TLS padlock not guarantee a site is honest?

3. What is the purpose of an operating system's memory management?

4. What is referential integrity?

DO NOW — CHECK / OBJECTIVES

Correct and improve

Check page 1 in GREEN PEN. Write corrections in full.

1. Model answer

No. A licence or applicable exception is required.

2. Model answer

Encryption in transit does not establish trustworthiness of operator.

3. Model answer

Allocating and protecting memory for running programs.

4. Model answer

Foreign keys refer to valid parent keys, subject to allowed NULL/policies.

By the end, you can…

• RIPA 2000 sets out specified investigatory powers and safeguards; provisions have changed over time.

• Investigatory Powers Act 2016 and later changes govern major communications powers and oversight.

• Intrusion should be assessed against lawful authority, necessity, proportionality and oversight.

• Evaluate wider 1.5.2 trade-offs involving censorship, online harm, automated work and environmental effects.

Vocabulary — know these terms

RIPA 2000 — Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000, historically specified by OCR.

IPA 2016 — Investigatory Powers Act 2016, governing major modern powers.

necessity — Intrusive step is needed for a legitimate legal aim.

proportionality — Intrusion is proportionate to the objective and circumstances.

NEW LEARNING

Read, annotate and explain

OCR historic reference

RIPA 2000 sets out specified investigatory powers and safeguards; provisions have changed over time.

Current landscape

Investigatory Powers Act 2016 and later changes govern major communications powers and oversight.

Weigh safeguards

Intrusion should be assessed against lawful authority, necessity, proportionality and oversight. A different OCR requirement, 1.5.2 , considers broader ethical choices: a legally permitted technology can still introduce censorship, biased decisions, intrusive monitoring or avoidable environmental harm.

Explain one step in your own words, using the correct technical terms.

I DO — WORKED EXAMPLE

Follow the worked method

A public authority requests covert interception of communications to investigate a serious threat. Is 'for public safety' alone an adequate legal justification?

Identify proposed interception

Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

Check lawful powers

Discuss which law or safeguard fits the situation.

Authorisation + oversight

No. Relevant statutory powers, lawful authorisation, necessity, proportionality and appropriate safeguards/oversight must be considered. Exact procedures depend on activity and legal power. OCR names RIPA 2000, while IPA 2016 now covers major investigatory communications powers.

Recognise possible harms

Some posts may be abusive, threatening or expose private information; targeted moderation can support safeguarding. Copyright-infringing uploads raise a different question from merely unpopular opinions.

Explain censorship risk

Over-broad filtering can silence lawful critique and reduce access to information. Offensive content is not automatically a computer-misuse offence; judge conduct, context and applicable rules separately.

Model a proportionate decision

Publish clear rules, distinguish criticism from harassment, review disputed removals and offer an appeal route. Explain which safeguards are legal obligations and which are additional ethical choices .

WE DO — GUIDED PRACTICE

Try → Discuss → Improve

YOU DO — INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Questions · Part 1

Answer independently. Show code, calculations, a trace or justified reasoning as appropriate.

Question 1

State why RIPA 2000 appears in OCR H446 1.5.1 and name one modern related Act. [6]

Question 2

Explain necessity and proportionality in the context of a proposed surveillance measure. [6]

YOU DO — INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Questions · Part 2

Answer independently. Show code, calculations, a trace or justified reasoning as appropriate.

Question 3

A public authority wishes to inspect communications data during a serious investigation. Assess four issues it must consider before taking action. [8]

EXIT TICKET / REFLECTION

Check your understanding

Complete the actual lesson Exit Ticket before checking the answer.

Any school or authority may secretly intercept communications whenever it believes doing so is useful.

How confident are you? Circle one: Confident / Getting there / Need help

Explain your choice, identifying one concept you can now use independently.

GREEN PEN — Correct and explain

Choose one mistake from your independent work. Write the correct method and explain precisely why your original answer was wrong.

Next step: revisit the model or a relevant revision-guide section if needed.